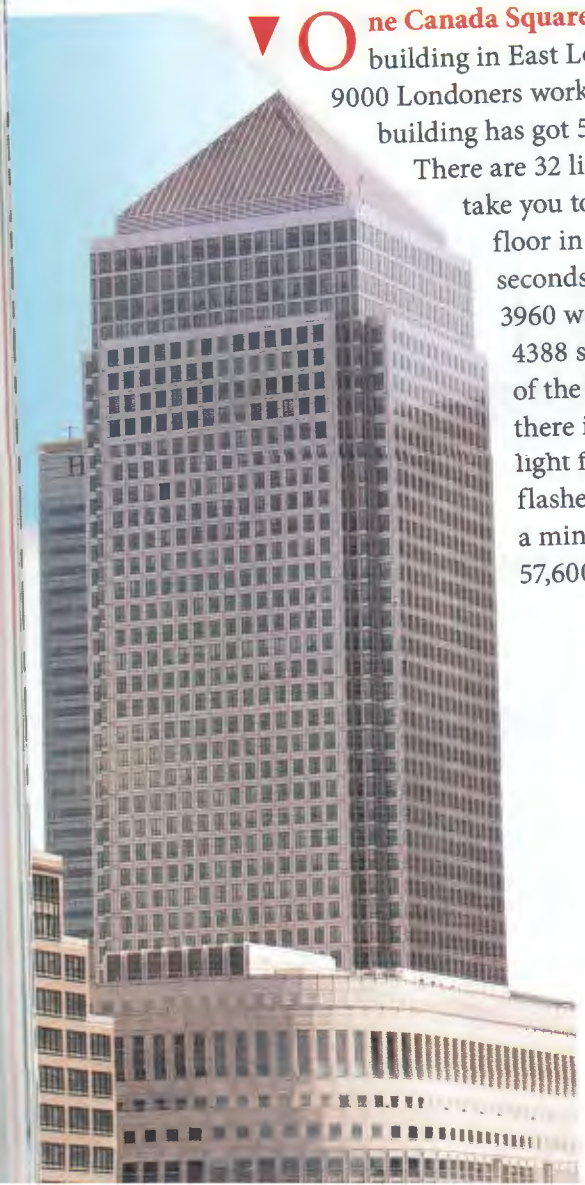
Culture page

A. What have the buildings in the pictures got in common? Listen, read and find out.

What's up there?

Buckingham Palace is one of the Queen's many homes. It's got 775 rooms! There are about 200 bedrooms and 78 bathrooms. It has even got a swimming pool, a cinema and a post office. Around the palace, there's a lovely large garden with a beautiful lake in it.





One Canada Square is a large building in East London. Over 9000 Londoners work there. This building has got 50 floors. There are 32 lifts and they take you to the 50th floor in only 40 seconds. It's also got 3960 windows and 4388 steps. On top of the building, there is a warning light for planes. It flashes 40 times a minute. That's 57,600 times a day!



30 St Mary Axe is a building people stop to look at. It has got 41 floors and about 5500 windows. There are 2074 steps, but people use one of the 23 lifts. At the very top, there is a fantastic restaurant with a great view. There aren't any walls around this restaurant, just windows. Many Londoners go up there for lunch or dinner and to enjoy the view.

B. Read again. What do the numbers refer to? Match.

1. 78	a. the number of lifts in 30 St Mary Axe
2. 23	b. the number of windows in One Canada Square
3. 3960	c. the number of rooms in Buckingham Palace
4. 775	d. the number of bathrooms in Buckingham Palace
5. 32	e. the number of windows in 30 St Mary Axe
6. 5500	f. the number of lifts in One Canada Square

You can find more information on this topic at